

SOUTHERN CHRISTIAN ADVOCATE.

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PROSPECTUS

SOUTHERN CHRISTIAN ADVOCATE.

At the late General Conference of the Methodist Episcopal Church, resolutions were passed, authorizing the publication of weekly religious papers, on the same footing with the Christian Advocate and Journal (New-York) and the Western Christian Advocate (Cincinnati) at Richmond, Nashville, and Charleston.

The act of the General Conference authorizing these publications, was called for by the Southern Decades, on the ground of its being necessary to an equal distribution of the benefits of the Church's press to all parts of her communion; and, especially, in view of the peculiar political aspect of the times. Within the range contemplated for the paper at Charleston, leaving equal scope for those at Richmond and Nashville, there are about fifty thousand whites in the membership of the Church. Here then are, probably, ten thousand Methodist families, and a much greater number attached to the Methodist, who have no weekly paper published among them. This, under any circumstances, might be held a sufficient reason for the publication we propose; but considered in connection with the feeling which is known to pervade all classes of men on the subject of our domestic institutions, it not only justifies our undertaking as one that is expedient, but strongly urges it as necessary to the Church.

We propose, therefore, to publish at the city of Charleston, as soon as the subscription lists shall warrant it, a weekly religious paper, to be entitled THE SOUTHERN CHRISTIAN ADVOCATE, which shall be zealously devoted to the promotion of good morals and religion—to give expression to the views and feelings of our people, kindly but firmly, on all subjects bearing on the Church—and to forward the cause of Christian benevolence, as embodied in the Bible, Missionary, Sunday School, Tract, and Temperance Societies.

This paper shall be printed on an imperial sheet, of the same size and quality with that of the Christian Advocate of New-York; with new type, long primer; and the typography, in all respects, shall equal the New-York paper.

The price will be THREE DOLLARS, to be paid in advance.

Subscription is paid within one month after receiving the first number, either to the Publishers or an authorized Agent, will be considered as in advance.

In any case of discontinuance during the year, the subscription for the year must be paid, and postage of the order to discontinue.

All communications, whether of business or matter for publication, unless remitting money, or subscriptions, to the amount of ten dollars, must be post paid.

Communications involving facts, or respecting persons, as, accounts of revivals or religious meetings, obituary notices, biographies, &c., must be accompanied with the writer's name.

Communications may be addressed to Rev. WILLIAM CAPERS, Charleston.

The Itinerant Ministers and Preachers of the Methodist Episcopal Church, are all authorized Agents of the Southern Christian Advocate, to whom payments may be made.

The proceeds of this paper, as a part of the general Book Concern, will be equally divided among all the Annual Conferences, to be applied in spreading the Gospel, and aiding distressed and superannuated Ministers, and the Widows and Orphans of those who have died in the work.

MEMOIR OF REV. MOSES MURRAY.

BY REV. SAMUEL DUNWOODY.

The Rev. Moses Murray was born in the Parish of St. James, Goose Creek, So. C., on the 8th of September, 1771. Of his early religious impressions, little is known at present, more than that he had a pious mother, who, as a goodly admonition frequently made a strong effect upon him. He lived, however, to be about twenty-seven years old, before he made a public profession of religion. He then joined the Methodist Episcopal Church, in his own house, where he was used as a preaching place, until the ministry of the Rev. George Clark, who was travelling the Bristol Circuit. Religion was at that time at a very low ebb in the neighborhood where he lived; and a little flock was soon he united, but to contend with much opposition. But his profession was perfectly sincere, and about six months after he had joined on trial, he found the pearl of great price in the forgiveness of his sins. From this time he went on valiantly in the ways of the Lord, and it might not be saying too much of him, to say, that from the day he first professed to find peace with God, to that of his death, few ever lived more unblameably than he did.

A few years after his conversion, he was licensed to exhort, and subsequently to preach among us. As a preacher, his talents were not great; but he was eminently useful. There was always such unctious attention what he said, that the sincere never failed of edification, and even careless sinners could not hear him without influence. About twelve years before his death, he professed to obtain the witness of a true sanctification, or perfect love; and his happy fruits were ever afterwards exhibited in his life. In the course of last year, he had a violent attack of fever, so that his life was despaired of. From this he was partially recovered; but his health was never entirely restored. In April last he was taken with a violent cold, followed with cerebral fever, which terminated in mortal existence on the 31 day of May; about thirty-nine years after he had become a member of the visible Church of Christ. The scenes of his death-bed might have been more interesting than they were, but for the sudden failure of his strength, which prevented him from saying all he wished to say. The last words he is remembered to have uttered distinctly, were "I am going through the valley and shadow of death, but I fear no evil, for the Lord is with me, and his rod and his staff they comfort me." Thus lived and died our excellent brother, Moses Murray, a witness of perfect love. It was matter of regret to his friends, and he seemed to sympathize with them in it, that his extreme bodily weakness prevented his expressing himself in his last hours as fully as he otherwise might, of God's most gracious dealings with him. As far, however, as he had strength to do so, he exhorted all around him; and affectionately and solemnly charged them to meet him in heaven.

The writer of this memoir regrets his not having been enabled to procure a fuller account of the life of this man of God. And all that is in his power to add, is a brief sketch of some traits of his character, which he believes will be at once recognized by all who had any personal acquaintance with him. 1. His simple, amiable, affectionate, pious;—which if he was opposed at all, was sure to disarm opposition without strife, and secure to him the confidence of even the most careless person; whilst for the same cause, his society was always pleasant and edifying to the religious. Indeed, simplicity and godly sincerity, blended with great good humor and meekness,

formed his most striking characteristic as a Christian. 2. Another striking trait of his character, was his indefatigable industry. While he was "not slothful in business," as respected temporal things, he was eminently "fervent in spirit in serving the Lord." As a local preacher, he went, to the utmost he was able, far and near, calling sinners to repentance; and the amount of good he was instrumental in doing was very great. Nor was it in the pulpit only that he labored for the souls of men. As time and opportunity offered, he went from house to house, exhorting, he had any intercourse with, to flee the wrath to come, and be saved from their sins.

3. He was emphatically "a lover of hospitality." And it becomes us particularly well to record this among his christian virtues; for what preacher ever came within his reach, who did not find his house a happy home? 4. He was eminently an example for his mild, affectionate, and successful government of his family. And no less so for the amiable christian and ministerial influence which he exerted in his neighborhood. Indeed, such was the meek and loving spirit he possessed, that he was always calm and unruffled under trials, and his presence was apt to allay any unhappy excitement which might disturb the equanimity of his neighbors. 5. Lastly, it could not be forgot to reckon among his shining virtues, his patient resignation to the will of God. This was especially manifested in his last illness. Not a murmuring word, or impatient or complaining look, escaped him. He so firmly believed the Lord does not willingly afflict the children of men, but for their good only, that it was invariably the language of his heart, "Not my will, but thine be done." In short, sanctified by grace, he was more than equal to the conflict, both of pain and death; and without doubt or fear, resigned his soul into the hands of the Saviour, whom he had so long loved and followed. "Blessed are the dead who die in the Lord. From henceforth, rest with the Spirit, for they rest from their labors, and their works do follow them."

RIGHT USE OF THE MEANS OF GRACE.

There are some actions which are usually reckoned as parts of our religion, which yet of themselves are so relative and imperfect, that without the purity of intention they degenerate; and unless they be directed and proceed on to those purposes which God designed them to, they return into the family of common, secular, or sinful actions. Thus alms are for charity, fasting for temperance, prayer for religion, humiliation for humility, austerity or self-denial is in order to the virtue of patience; and when these actions fall of their several ends, or are not directed to their own purposes, alms are misapplied, fasting is an impertinent trouble, prayer is but lip-labor, humiliation is but hypocrisy, self-denial is but vexation; for such were the aims of the Puritans, the first of Zebedee, the prayer of Judah (rejoice) by the prophet Isaiah, the humiliation of Anab, the martyrdom of heretics; in which nothing is given to God but the body, or the forms of religion, but the soul and the power of godliness is woefully wanting.—*Jer. Taylor.*

CREDULITY AND FAITH.

The difference between credulity and faith may be thus defined: faith is an act of the mind confiding in the power and faithfulness of God, an omnipotent and all-wise being, whose ability and wisdom are both equal to effect any event within the range of human expectation or desire; credulity generally has reference to the deeds or powers of mankind, and is, consequently, as fallacious as man is powerless, and circumscribed both in ability and wisdom. Thus faith believes that God will raise the countless millions of the dead as easily as he raises the desolations of winter by the renovation of spring, while credulity weakly and foolishly supposes that certain medicinal herbs, or the nostrums of the quacks, have power to stay the hand of disease, or kindle up life "beneath the ribs of death."

The greatest stretch of faith is an open and undeniable exercise of reason. The lowest degree of credulity is a reasonable and cannot claim an argument in its support. Thus, it is reasonable to believe that the body of Christ can cleanse our souls from every stain, because he is "very God of very God;" but it would be unreasonable and credulous to believe that the body of a martyr could ever if truly preserved in a phial, as at Loretto, could be of the least efficacy in procuring good or averting evil.

Credulity believes in the efficacy of charms, the power of witchcraft, and worships at the throne of fortune; but faith trusts only in God, believing that the word and promise of a being so perfect in ability and power can never fail. Credulity believes in a tale or a legend, suffers from the fear of ghost and spectral apparitions, and turns pale at a sign in the lamp or at an unknown sound; but faith is science and evidence; it uses the demonstrations of science as aids in the accumulation of evidence, and faith itself is but a simple evidence of unseen realities. Faith believes that the Lord Jesus will one day be revealed in flaming fire, borne on the surges of the billowy heavens as they flee from his coming, because that his coming is as a wonder no greater than his science unfolds in the every day operations of nature. The formation and development of a thunder storm, is as much a proof of God, as his final coming in judgment will be. The powers of the human mind would every intelligent person is conscious of possessing, and which every one knows equally as well, were derived from some high and indecipherable source, are as much a wonder and mystery, as the inspiration of a Holy Spirit, or the existence of a spirit world. The principles of gravitation which direct and control matter, are as wonderful as the eternal principles of right and wrong, which the same Almighty hand has connected with his moral government.

The philosophic student of cause and effect, will not fail to find the index of creation pointing upward. To God—to God, the final ascriptions of all nature ascend. Thus faith in God is truly reasonable, and bears some resemblance to a beautiful function which a noble-minded man will detect in his own bosom. He knows that his friend has the most entire confidence in his ability and willingness to accomplish his desires, which he has promised to do; and this confidence awakens a strange love in the bosom of the being so confided in towards the trusting one; it is, indeed, the surest guarantee that the desired good will be obtained. Love and confidence beget love and confidence in return. We throw ourselves out of the objects and range of sense when we trust God in our highest-reaching and sublimest acts of faith; thus God is honored by our unbounded confidence. Indeed, whom should we trust and confide in, if it were not our Heavenly Father!

Faith does not so much relate to temporal as spiritual blessings, because that temporal good is

an object of sense, and to a great extent, the result of natural causes and effects which it is our duty to study and learn—while spiritual blessings alone come directly from the unseen world—from moral influences impalpable to the organs of the senses—and from the direct relations which God has instituted between himself and those who are at peace with his moral government.—*Miss. Chris. Herald.*

PURITY OF INTENTION.

As to know the end distinguishes a man from a beast, so to choose a good end distinguishes a good man from an evil man. Hezekiah rejected his good deeds upon his sick bed, and obtained favor of God; but the Pharisee was accounted insolent for doing the same thing; because this man did it to uphold his name, the other to obtain a mercy of God. Zacharias questioned with the angel about his message, and was made speechless for his incredulity; but the blessed Virgin Mary questioned, and was blameless; for she did it to inquire after the manner of the thing, but he did not believe the thing itself; he doubted of God's power or the truth of the messenger; but she only of her own incapacity. This was it which distinguished the mourning of David from the exclamation of Saul; the confession of Pharaoh from that of Manasse; the tears of Peter from the repentance of Judas: "For the praise is not in the deed done, but in the manner of its doing. If a man visits his sick friend, and watches at his pillow for charity sake, and because of his old affliction, we approve it; but if he does it in hope of legacy, he is a vulture, and only watches for the carcass. The same things are honest and dishonest: the manner of doing them, and the end of the design, makes the separation."

Holy intention is to the actions of a man that which the soul is to the body, or form to its matter, on the root to the tree, or the sun to the world, or the fountain to a river, or the base to a pillar: for without these the body is a dead trunk, the matter is sluggish, the tree is a block, the world is darkness, the river is quickly dry, the pillar rushes into fitness and ruin; and the action is sinful, or unprofitable and vain. The poor farmer that gave a dish of cold water to Artaxerxes, was rewarded with a golden goblet, and he that gives the same to a disciple, in the name of a disciple, shall have a crown; but if he gives water in despite, when the disciple needs wine or a cordial, his reward shall be to want that water to cool his tongue.—*Jer. Taylor.*

"STAND AND WATCH."—EPH. VI. 14.

The Christian must stand upon his watch as a sentry. The lamp of God in the tabernacle was to burn always; (Exo. xxv. 37, xxx. 8.) that is, always in the night. And what is our life in this world but a dark night of temptation? Take heed, Christian, that thy watch light go not out in any part of this darksome time, lest time enemy come upon thee in that hour. He can find thee, but how canst thou resist him in the dark? If thy eyes are once closed in spiritual slumber, thou art a fair mark for his wrath, and know then, thou canst not be long off thy watch, but Satan will discover it! He knew the apostles' sleeping time, and then he desired leave to winnow them. (Luke xxii.) When the soul lies most secure and thinks her danger farthest off, then it is nearest; therefore labor to be constant in all thy holy care; the want of this spoils all. Some appear very careful for a time after they are newly come out of the furnace of affliction. O how nice and scrupulous are they while the smell of fire is about them, and the memory of their distress is fresh! They are as tender of sinning as one that comes out of a hot close room is of the air, they shrink at every breath of temptation stirring. But, alas, how soon they are hardened to commit those sins, without remorse, the bare mention of which, but a little before, troubled and afflicted them. Joseph relates that the sons of Noah, for some years after the flood, dwelt on the tops of high mountains, not daring to take up their habitation on the lower ground for fear of being drowned by another flood; yet, in process of time (as no flood came) they ventured down to the plain of Shinar, where their former fear was dead in one of the boldest, proudest attempts against God that the Sun ever witnessed; I mean the building of a tower whose top should reach to heaven. (Gen. x. 4.) Thus often we see God's judgments leave such an impression on men's spirits, that, for a while, they stand aloof from their sins, (as they of old on their hills) afraid to come down; but after a time they can descend to their former practices, and grow more bold and heaven-daring than ever. But if thou wilt be a CHRISTIAN indeed, keep on thy watch still, remit not thy care. Hast thou run well hitherto? O! do not down like a lazy traveller, by the way side to sleep, but reserve thy resting time till thou gettest home out of all danger. Thy God rested not till the last day's work in the Creation was finished; neither do thou cease to work or work till thou canst say thy salvation work is finished.

GURNALL.

THE SCRIPTURES.

From the London Wesleyan Methodist Magazine.

THE LOCUSTS EAT BY ST. JOHN THE BAPTIST.

REMARKS ON MATTHEW, III. 4.

"His meat was locusts and wild honey," which the poor people in Palestine eat, and which the law permitted to the Jews; for there is no necessity of saying with St. Isidore of Seville, that these were the ends and extremities of herbs, and the branches of trees. Mr. Morrison, Duke and Knight of St. Sepulchre, in his historical relation of a journey made to Mount Sinai and Jerusalem, says, that locusts abound in the desert where the Holy Precursor was, that they are as large as a person's thumb, that the peasantry cut off their legs and dry them in the sun; that, when thus dried, they have a taste much like a hazel nut, or filbert.

In the Encyclopedia we read, the Acridophaga, in ancient geography, were an Ethiopian people, represented as inhabiting near the deserts, and to have fed on locusts, as their name imports. Diodorus and Strabo give the following account of them: "Their stature was lower than that of other men, and they were meagre and extremely black. In the spring, high west winds drove from the deserts to their quarters, locusts of an extraordinary size, and remarkable for the squalid color of their wings. So great was the number of these insects, that they were the only sustenance of the Barbarians, who took them in the following manner:—At the distance of some stadia from their habitations, there was a wide and deep valley; they filled this valley with wood and wild herbs, with which their country abounded. When the cloud of locusts appeared, which were driven on by the wind, they set fire to the fuel which they had collected; the smoke which arose

from this immense fire was so thick, that the locusts, in crossing the valley, were stifled by it, and fell in heaps on the ground. The passage of the locusts being thus intercepted for many days, they made a large provision of these insects. As their country produced great quantities of salt, they salted them to make them more palatable, and to make them keep till next season."

It is well known that to this day the inhabitants of Ethiopia, Arabia, &c., frequently used locusts as food. Dr. Hasselquist, who travelled in Syria so late as 1752, with a view to improve natural history, informs us that he asked Franks and many other people who had lived in their countries if they ever heard that the inhabitants of Arabia, Ethiopia, &c., used locusts as food; they answered, they had. He likewise asked the question of Armenians, Copts, &c., who lived in Arabia, and had travelled in Syria, and near the Red Sea, and some of them said they had often seen the people eat these insects. He at last obtained complete satisfaction on this head from a learned Scribe at Cairo, who had lived six years at Mecca. This gentleman told him, in the presence of M. Le Grand, (the principal French interpreter at Cairo,) and others, that a famine frequently raged at Mecca when there is a scarcity of corn in Egypt, which obliges the inhabitants to live upon coarser food than ordinary; that when corn is scarce, the Arabians grind the locusts in hand-mills, or bruise them in stone mortars, and bake them in cakes, and use these cakes instead of bread; that he has frequently seen locusts used by the Arabians even when there was no scarcity of corn; when they boil them, stew them with butter and make them into a kind of fricasse, which, he says, is not disagreeably tasted, and that he had sometimes tasted these fricasses out of curiosity. A traveller informs us, that locusts sometimes afford a high treat to the more unpolished and remote hordes of the Hottentots; when, sometimes happens, after an interval of eight, ten, fifteen, or twenty years, they make their appearance in incredible numbers. The Hottentots are highly rejoiced at the arrival of these locusts, though they are sure to devour every kind of verdure on the ground. But the Hottentots make themselves amply amends for their loss, by falling foul on the animal themselves, eating them in such quantities as, in the space of a few days, to get visibly fatter than they were before. The Abbot Pareit, also informs us that the Moors make locusts a part of their food; that they go to hunt them, fry them in oil and butter, and sell them publicly at Tunis and Boune. From all these accounts we see the folly of that dispute among interpreters, about the nature of John the Baptist's food, some making the original to signify the fruit of a certain tree, some a kind of bird, &c. But those who adhere to the literal meaning of the word, undoubtedly were not only more orthodox, but adopted the true opinion, and their argument would have been much stronger had they had an opportunity of quoting such authors as the above.

THE WITHERED FIG TREE.

ABRIDGED FROM CALMET.

There has been no little diversity of opinion among commentators on the subject of the barren fig tree, cursed by our Lord, Matth. xxi. 19, related also by Mark x. 12, in very noticeable terms, which I beg leave slightly to transcribe, and to paraphrase.

"Jesus coming early in the morning from Bethany, was hungry; seeing a fig tree, from afar, at such a distance that he could only discern its spread of leaves, he went to it, if perhaps (it is) he might find some figs on it, for it was not the usual season for figs to be fit for gathering on fig trees in general, (ὅτι γὰρ ὡς καὶ ὁ Ἰσραὴλ) but he found leaves only; and he said, none shall ever find fruit on thee hereafter."

It is inquired, if this was not the season for figs, with what propriety did our Lord curse this barren fig tree?

Some have rendered the words, "it was not a year for figs." This the Greek will not bear; but, if it would, to what purpose is this rendering? Some have wished to read, "it was the season for figs;" but this is violating the text, as the time was March 31, certainly long enough before the general fig season. Dr. Doddridge, and I believe, most writers with him, think this was of the early, the prime, the most delicate sort of figs; and ripe in April; but, certainly not so early as this time; moreover, in that case, what need of the Evangelist's "if perhaps?" since, then, there could be no such uncertainty as these words imply, in the expectation of finding fruit on it; because the fruit being barely ripe, could not be supposed to have been gathered from this tree. Matthew, who says nothing about its not being the fig season, omits also this "if perhaps." Besides, do such valuable kinds of trees grow by the road side? Our Lord was not cultivated by proprietors? Our Lord was going from Bethany to Jerusalem; I suppose along the common road-way, from one town to the other.

Let us see how this story will read after we have perused an extract from Norden's Travels in Egypt, vol. I. p. 79.

"I shall remark that they have in Egypt divers sorts of figs; but if there is any difference between them, a particular kind differs still more; I mean that which the sycamores bears, that they name in Arabic gomez. It was upon a tree of this sort, that Zacharias got up, to see our Saviour pass through Jericho.

"This sycamore is of the height of a beech, and bears its fruits in a manner quite different from other trees. It has them on the trunk itself, which shoots out little sprigs, in form of a grape stalk, at the end of which grows the fruit, close to one another, most like bunches of grapes. The tree is ALWAYS GREEN, and bears fruit several times in the year, without observing any certain seasons; for I have seen some sycamores that have fruit two months after others. The fruit has the figure and smell of real figs, but is inferior to them in the taste, having a disgusting sweetness. Its color is yellow, inclining to an ochre, shaded by a flesh color; in the inside it resembles the common figs, excepting that it has a blackish coloring, with yellow spots. This sort of tree is pretty common in Egypt. The (common) people, for the greater part, live on its fruit."

This author asserts that this kind of tree was that which Zacharias climbed to see Jesus, called a sycamore, Luke xix. 4. As there is no difficulty in admitting this opinion, for the same kind of tree as grew in the way to Jericho, might grow near Jerusalem, let us for the present adopt it; it will follow that as that tree stood by the way-side, so might this tree; and standing on such a public situation, I suppose neither was private property. So that our Lord, by withering the tree, did not injure any owner; it was not in the garden, nor was it of any kind usually planted against a wall, for such an one would not have borne the weight of Zacharias. This

tree is called by the general name *oxya*, both by Matthew and Mark; and in might well be of an inferior kind. Matthew adds, *plava single tree*; and by the account of Luke, it should appear that the sycamore into which Zacharias climbed, was unincumbered by others around it, which might hinder his view. "This tree is always green," doubtless with leaves; "it bears fruit several times in the year, so that a person viewing it at almost any time of the year from a distance, cannot determine whether it has fruit on it or not; which very well accounts for the 'if perhaps,' of Mark; and the advancing of Jesus towards it; as supposing this kind of tree might bear fruit, while it was not now the general season for gathering figs from the kinds usually cultivated. It is a wild, but edible kind of fig; the fare of the poorer people.

It is evident, 1st.—That our Lord might discern the leaves of the tree, and its general greenness arising from them, long before it was clear to observation, whether there were figs on the trunk of the tree or not. 2dly.—That though we commonly say our Lord cursed this fig tree, yet the expression, strictly speaking, is not correct. I conceive of our Lord as doing no more to this tree, than commanding it to *continue in its present state*, q. d. "As thou art now barren, barren remain; (no man has hitherto eat fruit from thee) let no man in future eat fruit from thee; that sterility which now renders thee unprofitable, shall continue to be thy character." In fact, then, the withering of the leaves was the only alteration which took place in the apparent state of this tree, and those leaves being wholly useless, though the tree might be said to be cursed by reason of this privation, yet this injury or curse, was only apparent, and not real. It was no diminution of any man's property; but was plainly saying, in action, as well as words, "this tree yields no fruit," let it not therefore produce leaves, to disappoint the appetite of any subsequent seeker of food from it. Whether this transaction was in any degree referable to the then state of the Jewish nation, is a subject into which I do not inquire; but general opinion inclines to that sentiment.

MONITORY.

We extract the following account from the Rev. T. Alden's collection of American Epitaphs and Inscriptions. It is truly admonitory to those who have vowed unto the Lord, in the time of danger, and performed it not.

"The Rev. John Gano gathered the first Baptist Society in the city of New-York, and became its pastor in 1762. He was a distinguished chaplain in the American Army during the revolutionary war. In 1788, he removed to Kentucky, and preached in various places, to great acceptance and the spiritual benefit of many. His days were ended at Frankfort in August, 1804, at the age of 77 years. From his private writings an interesting biographical memoir has been given to the public, which supersedes the necessity of enlarging, in this work, upon the character of this faithful and orthodox preacher of the gospel. The following anecdote, however, does not appear in that memoir, and is too important to be lost.

While in the ministry at New York, a certain man, who had lived in open hostility to the laws of God, a debauchee, a drunkard, a gambler, blasphemer, a reviler of every thing sacred, was suddenly seized with a most excruciating disorder, and his dissolution seemed to be fast approaching. However great were the pains of his body, yet greater were the tortures of his conscience. He sent for Mr. Gano; desired his earnest prayers; appeared to be penitent; and made many promises of amendment should his life be spared, of which he had very little expectation. Mr. Gano was importunate at the throne of grace for his recovery, and that he might have opportunity to carry his good resolutions into effect.

Contrary to the apprehensions of every one, he in a few days, obtained relief, & was restored to health; but, as too often has been the case, the vows and promises made in the hour of threatening danger were soon forgotten. Mr. Gano took an early occasion to remind him of the danger, from which he had almost miraculously escaped, and of the solemn purposes of reformation he had formed in the extremity of his distress. The man was impatient at the suggestion, said it was no time then to think of what he had promised when tortured by disease; and pursued the sinful pleasures of the world without controul.

An all-wise God saw fit, in a little while, to visit him with a return of the same excruciating disorder, and under circumstances of equal alarm. He now reflected upon the disregard he had shown to his vows and obligations. The terrors of the Lord were set before him in awful array. It now seemed to him that this repetition of the dread malady was a judgment of Heaven upon him for pursuing his midnight revels, drunkenness, impurity, and blasphemy, when he had, as it were, covenanted with God that if his life were prolonged, he would become a new creature. He sent for the same pious minister of the gospel, who, in reminding him of his former illness, promises, and subsequent wicked career, was anticipated by the unhappy man, who frankly charged himself with all the guilt he had incurred, was lavished in self-condemnation, and like a true penitent, could hardly ask for another opportunity to serve his Maker, when he had so obstinately abused that, which had been so wonderfully granted him. However, he, at length, said, if it were possible for him to recover, he should never, he was certain he should never again, give the adversary such an occasion of triumph.—He would renounce the company of his abandoned associates and would become a champion of the cross. Mr. Gano prayed with him and for him, like a wrestling Jacob, that his health might be restored; that he might evince to the world the sincerity of his heart by the holy life he should lead, and that an example of such solemn promises, once so criminally broken, but of which he now seemed so sincerely to repent, might be overruled in providence, to the glory of divine grace and to the good of his wicked associates.

In due time, the anguish of his disorder abated. He recovered again like one from the dead; but, awful to relate, he soon relapsed into all the viciousness of his former life, and was dead in trespasses and sins. He cast off all fear of God; no longer regarded the laws of that holy Being, whom he had so long despised, but whom he had so recently promised, in the most affecting manner to obey. He cared not for the vows he had made or the obligations he was under, but yielded, without restraint, to all the base propensities of his polluted heart.

Mr. Gano, as soon as in his power, administered his faithful admonitions, copiously enlarged upon the heaven-provoking aggravations of his guilt, and the awful condemnation which awaited

him. He was heard with reluctance, and the poor unhappy mortal rushed headlong into the vortex of dissipation, wretchedness, and ruin.

The spirit of God will not always strive with man. He was, at length, attacked by the same violent disorder, and death was fast approaching. However unwilling he was to hear the counsels and remonstrances of Mr. Gano in health, he was willing to send for him in his unutterable distress of body and mind. How often are those to be found, who have little regard for God and his institutions, when in health, yet, in the prospect of dissolution, are willing and eager to call on him for help, and to solicit Ministers and pious friends to call on him in their behalf.

Mr. Gano visited the unhappy man in his distress; but no tongue can describe the horrors of his mind, his pangs of remorse, more dreadful than the pangs of death.—There was no opportunity of conversation, such was his deplorable situation, agony, and heart-breaking state of despair. All which could be done, was to pray for him. Once more the pious servant of the Cross kneeled down by his bed in order to intreat the mercy of God; but what seemed like a special interposition of Heaven, Mr. Gano was unable to utter a single sentence! As soon as he opened his mouth to pray, he was seized with a fit of coughing, that his whole frame was convulsed. He paused till calmness had succeeded this unexpected and extraordinary incident. He then attempted once more, to pray, but was instantly affected in the same wonderful manner! At length, he became composed, and the third time exerted himself to offer up his petitions for his abandoned, despairing, dying fellow creature; but, the third time, he was affected in the same almost miraculous manner! He immediately rose and said, it was out of his power to pray. He was utterly unable to strive against such an evident interposition of God. Mr. Gano, however, thought that he would say, the Lord have mercy on him; but as he was about to pronounce these words, the unhappy man expired in a state of horror not to be described, and uttering blasphemies too awful to conceive! He that being often reproved, hardeneth his neck, shall suddenly be destroyed, and that without remedy.

MINISTERS.

From the Christian Advocate and Journal.

TALENT.

Some persons appear to possess a talent for one thing, and some for another; and when this natural inclination can be pursued, the individual becomes an adept in his calling. By dint of study a man may make some proficiency in that for which he seems to have no natural talent. But to employ one's talent improperly, is wrong as it counteracts the design of the Giver. And perhaps in nothing is this more apparent than in those ministers of the Gospel who possess a talent really to commit to memory the sayings of others, either spoken or written. This is a "gift" that all ministers might well "covet." But among those who possess it, how few use it according to the design of the Author! Commonly this excellent gift is employed to cull from various authors, and to arrange the whole with such ingenuity as to cause it to pass with the hearer for his own; and it would cause a blush of conscious guilt to suffuse the cheek to be charged with it.

What would a profound jurist conclude, were he to hear a lawyer deliver a learned speech made up of extracts from Blackstone, Littleton, Coke, &c., instead of using them as authorities! And just so it is with a minister of the Gospel. Let him advance any doctrine or matter of controversy between man and man; or between man and his Maker, and to show the congregation that he is not alone and unsupported, let him, out of the rich and well-stored treasury of his memory, quote from the Bible, from Wesley, Fletcher, Coke, Beason, Clarke, Watson, and others; and that too as copiously as he may, giving each his proper credit. Or, should he not be able to say to whom he is indebted for a certain sentence, he can say to an able writer; and thus show that these are used as authorities.

This talent, improperly employed serves no valuable purpose. A fine sermon may be delivered, but it will be without effect, i. e., it will not touch the heart; because it does not come from the heart, but from the head. And although it may gain for the preacher a name, and the applause of men, yet these shall be as "the morning cloud, and as the early dew;" for, just in proportion as he is known, will his standing be; and some who once applauded, will now hiss at him.

But let this talent be used agreeably to the design of the Giver, and the possessor cannot fail to rank among the first order of ministers, both in respect to popularity and usefulness.

I would, then, most earnestly recommend to all preachers who have this talent, to treasure up the most forcible sayings of the most distinguished writers, both ancient and modern, in prose and verse, and use them with an unsparing hand in all their public discourses, when they are applicable: not as their own, nor yet as anecdotes; but, as they truly are, the testimony of such and such distinguished men, going to support their views.

T. K. C.

HUMILITY.

From Jay's Life of the Rev. Cornelius Winter.

His humility was genuine and not assumed. It was not the humility that is founded in vanity, and employs a number of self-annihilating expressions, as anglers to fish for praise: a humility that retreats—to be followed; that refuses—to be courted; that disavows excellencies—for the satisfaction of inducing others to affirm what we possess them, and believe that we are capable of them. Reality needs no proof; but those who have neither the true sense of maintaining the reality, nor the grace to be very lavish in professions, heard Mr. Winter in his public ministrations, and the language of man himself, "dust and ashes." "Unworthy that their general carriage mean opinion of themselves would prob that would own 'voluntarily' able for use, they, and the great elements, sneaked using being to elive was